Chetanath Gautam, Ed.D.
Professor, Educational Leadership
Department of Education,
College of Humanities Education and Social Sciences (CHESS)
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Scholarly Interests

My research focuses on **scholar-practitioner educational leadership**, examining theory and practice through the lens of critical theories in P-20 settings. I am particularly interested in issues of **equity, justice, and culturally relevant leadership**, especially in high-need urban and rural schools in the United States and developing nations like Nepal. I employ transformative, mixed-method research approaches to explore the dynamic interaction between theory and practice and to address pressing educational challenges.

Education

Doctor of Education (Ed.D.), Educational Leadership (2015)

Stephen F. Austin State University, Nacogdoches, TX

- **Dissertation:** *Leadership Adventures of an Emerging Scholar-Practitioner: An Interpretive Autoethnography*
- **Chair:** Dr. Patrick M. Jenlink

Master of Philosophy (M.Phil.), Educational Leadership and Administration (2010)

Kathmandu University, Nepal

- **Thesis:** *Challenges and Issues of Continuous Assessment System in the Schools of Nepal: An Interpretative Narrative Study*

Master of Education (M.Ed.), Curriculum and Evaluation (2003)

Tribhuvan University, Nepal

Bachelor of Education (B.Ed.), Mathematics and Science Education (1999)

Tribhuvan University, Nepal

Academic Appointments

Professor of Educational Leadership | 2025– Present

Delaware State University, Dover, DE

Associate Professor of Educational Leadership | 2020–2025

Delaware State University, Dover, DE

Assistant Professor of Educational Leadership | 2016–2020

Delaware State University, Dover, DE

Post-Doctoral Research Associate | 2015–2016

Stephen F. Austin State University, Nacogdoches, TX

Doctoral Research Assistant | 2012–2015

Stephen F. Austin State University, Nacogdoches, TX

Assistant Professor | 2005–2012

Pashupati Multiple College (Affiliated with Tribhuvan University), Kathmandu, Nepal

Professional/ K-12 Experience

K-12 School Principal | 2006–2011

KMC School, Kathmandu, Nepal

Freelance Master Trainer | 2004–2011

National Center for Educational Development (NCED), Nepal

Assistant Principal | 2002–2004

United School, Lalitpur, Nepal

High School Teacher | 2000–2002

I. J. Pioneer School, Lalitpur, Nepal

Publications

Journal Articles (Peer-Reviewed)

Lowery, C. L., & **Gautam, C.** (2025). K12 superintendent awareness of critical race theory: Perspectives, perceptions, and presumptions. *Educational Administration Quarterly (EAQ), 61*(1), 400-433.

Rouser, S., **Gautam, C.**, & Lowery, C. L. (2024). When complexity and uncertainty became life: Delaware school principals' roles and leadership practices during COVID-19 crisis – A mixed method case study. *International Journal of Educational Leadership Preparation (IJELP), 19*(1), 157-182.

Lowery, C. L., **Gautam, C.**, & Hess, M E. (2024). Perceptions of political literacy among aspiring school leaders in a rural Midwest university preparation program. *International Journal of Educational Leadership Preparation (IJELP), 19*(1), 1-21.

Lowery, C. L., & **Gautam, C.** (2023). The impact of opioids on schools and students in Ohio. *Journal of Research Initiatives*, *8*(2), art. 6.

Gomez, C. J., **Gautam, C.**, Rothermel, M., & Olsen, J. (2020). Students' perceptions of a token economy in an undergraduate science flipped class-room. *Journal of the Scholarship of Teaching and Learning, 20*(2).

Lowery, C. L., **Gautam, C.**, Hess, M. E., & Mays, C. (2017). Rural superintendents as political agents: Grassroots advocacy in Appalachian districts of southeast Ohio. *Journal of Research Initiatives, 3*(1), art. 4.

Gautam, C., & Lowery, C. L. (2017). Teaching moral literacy through critical pedagogical bricolage: A co-constructed auto-ethnography of an educational leadership program. *The Qualitative Report (TQR), 22*(1), 160-178.

Gautam, C. (2016). Scholar–Practitioner Dynamics: A transformative and dynamic model of Educational Leadership. *Scholar-Practitioner Quarterly, 10*(3-4), 150-173.

Gautam, C., Lowery, C. L., Mays, C. D., & Durant, D. G. (2016). Challenges for global learners at a small-town university: A qualitative study of the concerns and difficulties of international students. *Journal of International Students, 6*(2), 500-525.

Lowery, C. L., **Gautam, C.**, & Mays, C. D. (2016). The praxis of Gandhi's satyagraha: The scholar–practitioner educational leader as moral "truth holder." *International Journal of Educational Leadership Preparation, 11*(2), 71-86.

Gautam, C., Alford, B. J. & Khanal, M. (2015). Sustaining school improvement through an external and internal focus: A case study of a high need secondary school in Nepal. *International Journal of Teacher Leadership, 6*(1), 1-17.

Lowery, C. L., **Gautam, C.**, & Mays, C. D. (2014). The Buddha metaphor: The teacher-seeker, the wheel-turner, the scholar–practitioner. *Scholar-Practitioner Quarterly, 8*(2), 109-125.

Edited Books

Lowery, C. L., **Gautam, C.**, Jenlink P.M. (Eds.). (In Press). Educational Leadership and Political Literacy: Empowering School Leaders for Informed Civic and Social Engagement. Bloomsbury.

Lowery, C. L., **Gautam, C.**, White, R., & Hess, M. E. (Eds.). (2023). *Educational leadership and critical theory: What can K12 leaders learn from the critical theorists?* (Educational Leadership Series). Bloomsbury.

Authored Books

Gautam, C. (in development). *Scholar-Practitioner Journeys: Blurring the Boundaries of Pedagogy, Practice and Research.*

Gautam, C., & Lowery, C. L. (in development). *Transformative and innovative educational & social research methods: Authentic inquiry for educational and social change*.

Refereed Book Chapters

Lowery, C. L., **Gautam**, C. and Jenlink, P. M. (in Press). The Intersection of Educational Leadership and Political Literacy. In C. L. Lowery, C. Gautam, C. and P. M. Jenlink, (Eds.), Educational Leadership and Political Literacy: Empowering School Leaders for Informed Civic and Social Engagement. Bloomsbury

Gautam, C. & Lowery, C.L. (in Press). Political Literacy for Forward Thinking. In C. L. Lowery, C. Gautam, C. and P. M. Jenlink, (Eds.), Educational Leadership and Political Literacy: Empowering School Leaders for Informed Civic and Social Engagement. Bloomsbury

Gautam, C. & Lowery, C.L. (in Press). Preparing Politically Literate Leaders by Reimagining Med, EdD, and PhD Pathways for Civic K12 Leadership. In C. L. Lowery, C. Gautam, C. and P. M. Jenlink, (Eds.), Educational Leadership and Political Literacy: Empowering School Leaders for Informed Civic and Social Engagement. Bloomsbury

Mitchell, T., **Gautam**, C. and Lowery, C. L. (in Press). - Chapter 5: Creative Maladjustment: Navigating Regressive Times through Political Literacy in Educational Leadership. In C. L. Lowery, C. Gautam, C. and P. M. Jenlink, (Eds.), Educational Leadership and Political Literacy: Empowering School Leaders for Informed Civic and Social Engagement. Bloomsbury

Lowery, C. L., **Gautam**, C. and Jenlink, P. M. (in Press).The Future of Political Literacy through the Lens of the Leadership Politic. In C. L. Lowery, C. Gautam, C. and P. M. Jenlink, (Eds.), Educational Leadership and Political Literacy: Empowering School Leaders for Informed Civic and Social Engagement. Bloomsbury

Gautam, C. (2023). Educational Leadership through the Lens of Critical Theory. In C. L. Lowery, C. Gautam, R. White, & M. E. Hess (Eds.), *Educational leadership and critical theory* (pp. 1-13). Bloomsbury.

Gautam, C., White, R., & Hess, M. E. (2023). Part 1: Critical Educational Leadership for Understanding School and Society through the Theoretical and Reflective Lenses. In C. L. Lowery, C. Gautam, R. White, & M. E. Hess (Eds.), *Educational leadership and critical theory*. Bloomsbury.

Gautam, C., & Lowery, C. L. (2025). Education in the remote village schools in Nepal: Encouraging innovation, critical thinking, and problem-solving. In J. D. Johnson & H. L. Harmon (Eds.), *International handbook of rural and remote education* (pp. 63–79). Edward Elgar.

Lowery, C. L., & **Gautam, C.** (2023). Collaborative autoethnography as bricolage: An authentic approach to constructing the eastern-western bridge in educational research. In E. A. Samier & E. S. El-Kaleh (Eds.), *Culturally sensitive research methods for academic administration and leadership: International perspectives on theory and practice* (pp. 137-150). Routledge.

Gautam, C., Rosario, A., & Alford, B. J. (2021). Sustained Community Engagement and Student Learning in High Need Schools: Roles of Trust, Purpose, and Actions. In B. Barnett, and P. Woods (Eds.), *Educational Leadership for Social Justice and Improving High Need Schools: Findings of Ten Years of International Collaboration*. Information Age Publishing.

Gautam, C., Alford, B. J., & Lowery, C. L. (2018). Local control of education challenges and opportunities: Stories of successful high need school leadership in Nepal. In I. del Arco Bravo & P. Silva (Eds.), *Tendencias nacionales e internationales en organización educativa: Entre la estabilidad y el cambio* (pp. 450-464). Wolters Kluwer.

Lowery, C. L., Walker, A., **Gautam, C.**, & Mays, C. D. (2015). DPPE and the scholar-practitioner: Accountability through care, collaboration, criticality, and commitment. In P. Tenuto (Ed.), *Renewed accountability for access and excellence: Applying a model for Democratic Professional Practice in Education* (pp. 261-278). Lexington.

Conference Presentations

Gautam, C. (2026, April 8). Preparing anti-racist/abolitionist educational leaders for transformative praxis [Roundtable presentation]. American Educational Research Association (AERA) Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA, United States.

Mitchell, T., & **Gautam, C.** (2026, April 11). Creative maladjustment: Navigating regressive times through political literacy in educational leadership [Paper presentation]. American Educational Research Association (AERA) Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA, United States.

Sasso, P., Alexandar, J. & **Gautam, C.** (2026, April 11). Culture shock on campus: Narratives of first-generation rural college students navigating their freshman year [Paper presentation].

American Educational Research Association (AERA) Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA, United States.

Gautam, C., Lowery, C. L., Mitchell, T., Rouser, S., & Burgos, L. (2025, November). *International perspectives on leadership* [Paper presentation]. University Council for Educational Administration, San Juan, Puerto Rico.

Lowery, C. L., & **Gautam, C.** (2025, November). *Blurring borders, crossing lines: At the crossroads of urban-rural solidarity in educational leadership* [Paper presentation]. University Council for Educational Administration, San Juan, Puerto Rico.

Lowery, C. L., Johnson, J. D., Militello, M., **Gautam, C.**, Red Corn, A., & Villalba, A. (2025, November). *Fostering rural partnerships for international, Indigenous, and immigrant spaces: Leading through collaboration and community-building* [Community-building session]. University Council for Educational Administration, San Juan, Puerto Rico.

Lowery, C. L., & **Gautam, C.** (2025, July). *Political literacy for forward-thinking, equitable, and globally conscious educational leadership* [Paper presentation]. International Council for Professors of Educational Leadership conference, virtual.

Lowery, C. L., **Gautam, C.**, Hess, M., & Walker, A. (2025, March). *Dewey's relevance and importance to scholar-practitioner programs in ed leadership: The current need and future promise of the philosophically-grounded EdD* [Paper presentation]. John Dewey Society Annual Conference, Baltimore, MD, United States.

Barakat, M., Bergeron, W., Brion, C., ... **Gautam, C.**, Karanxha, Z. Lowery, C. L., ... et al. (2024, November). *Research-in progress : Voices 5* [Working session]. University Council for Educational Administration (UCEA) conference, Los Angeles, CA, United States.

Lowery, C. L., & **Gautam, C.** (2023, April). *An interrogation in search of critical race truth: K12 superintendents' assumptions and Awareness of CRT in Schools* [Roundtable paper presentation]. American Educational Research Association Annual Conference, Chicago, IL, United States.

Lowery, C. L., & **Gautam, C.** (2023, April). *Political literacy and educational leadership: Perceptions of aspiring school administrators* [Roundtable paper presentation]. American Educational Research Association Annual Conference, Chicago, IL, United States.

Lowery, C. L., Hess, M. E. & **Gautam, C.** (2023, March). *Perspectives of political literacy among aspiring Appalachian school leaders in a university graduate program* [Paper presentation]. Appalachian Studies Association Annual Conference, Athens, OH, United States.

Rouser, S., **Gautam, C.**, & Lowery, C. (2022, November). *When complexity and uncertainty became life, school principals' roles and leadership practices during COVID-19 crisis* [Paper presentation]. University Council of Educational Administration (UCEA) Annual Convention, Seattle, WA, United States.

Lowery, C. L., **Gautam, C.**, Hess, M. E. (2022, November). *Is Critical Race Theory a curricular concern in K12 schools? What do school leaders say?* [Paper presentation]. American Educational Studies Association (AESA) Annual Conference, Pittsburgh, PA, United States.

Gautam, C., Lowery, C., & Hess, M. (2021, August). *Professors of educational leadership perceptions of Dewey's My Pedagogic Creed— And how it relates to developing principals as morally democratic agents* [Research presentation]. International Council of Professors of Educational Leadership (ICPEL) Annual Conference, virtual.

Lowery, C., **Gautam, C.**, & Hess, M. (2021, August). *The impact of opioids on Ohio students and schools: Principals and superintendents* [Paper presentation]. International Council of Professors of Educational Leadership (ICPEL) Annual Conference, virtual.

Gautam, C., Hess, M. E., & Lowery, C. L. (2020, April). *West Coast Principals' Perspectives on the Relevance of Dewey's Early Educational Values* [Paper Session]. AERA Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA (Conference Canceled).

Gautam, C., & Lowery, C. L. (2019, November). *"I was heartbroken, just wanted some HOPE": Story of successful high-need school leadership in Nepal* [Research presentation]. The 33rd Annual University Council of Educational Administration (UCEA) conference, New Orleans, LA.

Honors and Awards

Highly Commendable Research Award (2015)

UCEA-Consortium for Study of Leadership and Ethics in Education (CSLEE)

For the doctoral dissertation, "Leadership Adventures of an Emerging Scholar–Practitioner: An Interpretive Autoethnography."

UCEA Barbara L. Jackson Scholar (2013–2015)

M.Phil. Dissertation Award (2011)

University Grant Commission of Nepal

Dean's Award (2013)

Southwest Educational Research Association (SERA)

For the paper, "Elements that promote and hinder positive student-teacher relationships at the secondary level: Voices of the students."

Doctoral Research Assistant Fellowship (2012–2015)

Stephen F. Austin State University

Professional Service

Editorial and Peer Review

- **Editorial Advisory Board Member,** *Journal of Comparative Studies and International Education* (2019–Present)
- **Editorial Assistant,** *Scholar-Practitioner Quarterly* (2015–2017)
- **Ad-Hoc Manuscript Reviewer** for:
  - Educational Administration Quarterly
  - Journal of Educational Administration
  - *International Journal of Teacher Leadership*
  - *Journal of Current Psychology*
  - *Journal of International Students*
  - *Scholar-Practitioner Quarterly*
- **Conference Proposal Reviewer** for:
  - American Educational Research Association (AERA)
  - University Council of Educational Administrators (UCEA)
  - Transnational Education and Learning Society (TELS)

National and International Organizations

- **American Educational Research Association (AERA)**
  - Session Chair, AERA Annual Convention (2019, 2024)
  - Treasurer/Secretary, John Dewey Studies SIG (2021–2022)
  - Communications Officer, John Dewey Studies SIG (2019–2021)
- **University Council of Educational Administrators (UCEA)**
  - Jackson Scholar Mentor
  - Member, International School Leadership Development Network (ISLDN) Research Team
- **John Dewey Society**
  - Member

University and Community Service

- **University P&T Committee Member,** Delaware State University
- **University IRB Committee Member,** Delaware State University
- **Faculty Senator,** Delaware State University (2019–2023)
- **Coordinator,** CAEP SPA Report for Educational Leadership Graduate Programs (2017, 2019, 2023)
- **Coordinator,** Education Graduate Programs (2019–2020)
- **Contributor,** Food Bank of Delaware